Year 6 Admission Assessment

Version 3.1, October 2026

Name	
Date	

Welcome!

These activities help us get to know you. Do your best. It is fine if you cannot answer every question. You can ask your teacher to say the instructions again.

How to answer

Tick one box. Which one is an animal? a chair ☐ a cat ☑

Write your answer in the box. 5 + 3 = **8**

Circle the biggest number. 4 (9) 6

Join the picture to its word.



Show your working. 26 + 17 = **43**

Working: 20 + 10 = 30 6 + 7 = 13 30 + 13 = 43

The parts of this booklet

Part		Time
1	Listening	5 minutes
2	Reading	12 minutes
3	Writing	10 minutes
4	Maths	18 minutes
5	Science	8 minutes

Your teacher will tell you when to start each part.

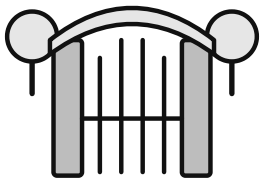
Part 1: Listening

Your teacher will read the questions to you. Then your teacher will read a conversation **two times**.

Listen carefully. **Answer** the questions on this page and the next page.

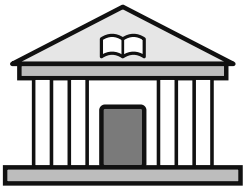
1 / 1

Where will Aisha and Jun meet? **Tick** one box.



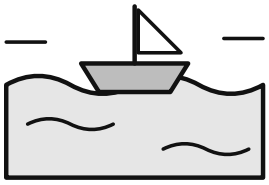
park gate

A ☐



library

B ☐

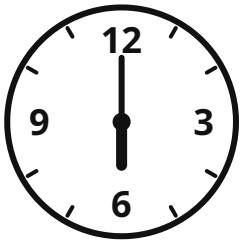


river

C ☐

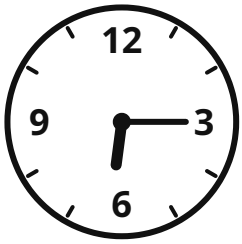
2 / 1

What time will they meet? **Tick** one box.



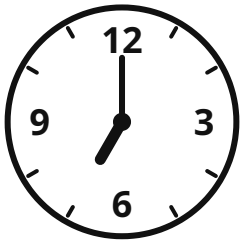
6:00

A ☐



6:15

B ☐



7:00

C ☐

3 / 1

What must Jun bring? **Tick** two boxes.



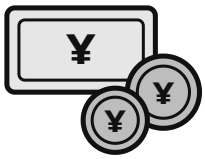
jacket

A ☐



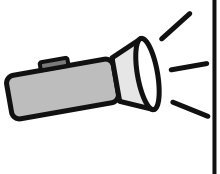
umbrella

B ☐



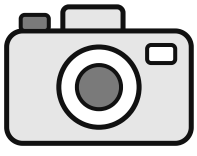
money

C ☐



torch

D ☐



camera

E ☐

4 / 1

Who is going to the film night with Aisha? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ her mum
- ☐ her dad and her little brother
- ☐ her cousin

5 / 1

How wide is the screen?

Write your answer in the box.

☐ metres

6 / 1

What can they buy in the park?

Write your answer in the box.

☐

7 / 1

Why does Aisha change the place where they meet?

Write your answer.

8 / 1

Jun's piano lesson finishes at six o'clock. Will he be late? **Tick** one box.

Yes ☐ No ☐

Explain your answer.

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part 2: Reading

Read the texts and **answer** the questions.

Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.

Part A

Read the menu. Then answer questions 1 to 7.

Panda Café

Open 7:30 to 20:00. Closed on Mondays.

Food

Noodle soup	**¥18**
Fried rice	**¥15**
Dumplings (10 on a plate)	**¥20**
Egg sandwich	**¥12**

Drinks

Orange juice (cold)	**¥8**
Milk tea (hot or cold)	**¥10**
Hot chocolate	**¥9**

= spicy

Special offer! Every Wednesday:
children under 12 get a free drink with any food.

1 / 1

How much is one plate of dumplings?

Write your answer in the box.

¥ ☐

2 / 1

How many dumplings are on one plate?

Write your answer in the box.

☐

3 / 1

Which food is spicy? **Tick** one box.



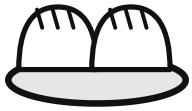
noodle soup

A ☐



fried rice

B ☐



dumplings

C ☐

4 / 1

Which drink can be hot or cold?

Write your answer in the box.

5 / 1

What time does the café close?

Write your answer in the box.

6 / 2

Tick True or False.

	True	**False**
Example: You can buy orange juice at the café.	☑	☐
The café is open on Mondays.	☐	☐
Fried rice costs more than an egg sandwich.	☐	☐

7 / 1

Wang Hao is 10 years old. On Wednesday, he buys fried rice at the café.

What does he get for free? **Write** your answer in the box.

Part B

Read the story. Then answer questions 8 to 15.

The Rainy Day Picnic

On Sunday morning, Sofia and her little brother Tom were ready for a picnic in the park. Mum had made sandwiches, and Dad had packed some fruit and a big red blanket.

Then Sofia looked out of the window. Dark clouds were rolling across the sky. A moment later, rain began to beat against the glass.

"Oh no," said Tom. His face crumpled, and he looked as if he was going to cry.

Sofia had an idea. She pushed the sofa back against the wall and spread the red blanket on the living-room floor. Then she put Tom's toy animals all around the edge of the blanket.

"Welcome to the indoor park!" she said.

Dad played birdsong on his phone. Mum put a big plant in the middle of the blanket and called it a tree. They ate their sandwiches on the floor, and Tom gave pretend grapes to his toy lion.

After lunch, the rain stopped and the sun came out. But nobody wanted to go to the park.

"Can we have an indoor picnic every Sunday?" asked Tom.

8 / 1

On which day was the picnic?

Write your answer in the box.

9 / 1

Tick the **two** things that Dad packed.

- ☐ fruit
- ☐ sandwiches
- ☐ a blanket
- ☐ a ball

10 / 1

What colour was the blanket?

Write your answer in the box.

11 / 1

What did Mum use as a tree?

Write your answer in the box.

12 / 1

Why could the family not go to the park in the morning?

13 / 1

What did Sofia put around the edge of the blanket?

14 / 1

"His face crumpled, and he looked as if he was going to cry." How did Tom feel?

Tick one box.

- ☐ sad
- ☐ happy
- ☐ hungry
- ☐ angry

15 / 1

When the sun came out, nobody wanted to go to the park. Why do you think this was?

Part C

Read the text. Then answer questions 16 to 23.

How Seeds Travel

A plant cannot walk, but its seeds can travel a long way. Why does this matter? If every seed fell straight down under its parent plant, the young plants would grow in the shade. They would also have to share water and space with the parent and with each other, and most of them would not survive. So plants have clever ways of sending their seeds away. Scientists call this seed dispersal.

Carried by the wind. Some seeds are so light that the wind can carry them. A dandelion seed has a tiny parachute of soft hairs, which can carry it a long way on a breezy day. A sycamore seed has a wing. As it falls, it spins like a small helicopter, and the wind pushes it away from the tree.

Floating on water. The coconut is one of the largest seeds in the world. Its thick, hairy outer layer traps air, so it floats. A coconut can drift on the ocean for months before it washes up on a beach and starts to grow.

Hitching a ride. Some seeds travel on animals. A burdock seed is covered in tiny hooks that catch on fur. In 1941, a Swiss engineer called George de Mestral noticed burdock seeds stuck to his dog's coat after a walk. He looked at them under a microscope and saw the hooks. This gave him an idea: he invented a fastener with tiny hooks and loops, which we now call Velcro. You may have it on your shoes or your school bag.

Other seeds are hidden inside sweet fruits. When a bird eats the fruit, the seeds pass through its body and are dropped somewhere new, often far from the parent plant.

16 / 1

What helps a dandelion seed travel on the wind?

17 / 1

Why can a coconut float?

18

/ 1

Find and copy one word from "Carried by the wind" that means "not heavy".

light

Find and copy one word from the first paragraph that means "stay alive".

19

/ 1

"A coconut can **drift** on the ocean for months." What does **drift** mean here? **Tick** one box.

- [ ] sink to the bottom
- [ ] move slowly with the water
- [ ] swim fast
- [ ] break into pieces

20

/ 1

One heading is "Hitching a ride". What does this mean in the text? **Tick** one box.

- [ ] being carried by an animal
- [ ] growing very tall
- [ ] falling straight down
- [ ] floating on the sea

21

/ 1

Give **one** reason why young plants do not grow well right under their parent plant.

22

/ 1

A bird eats a cherry in a park. Later, a small cherry tree starts to grow in a garden far away. **Explain** how this can happen.

23

/ 1

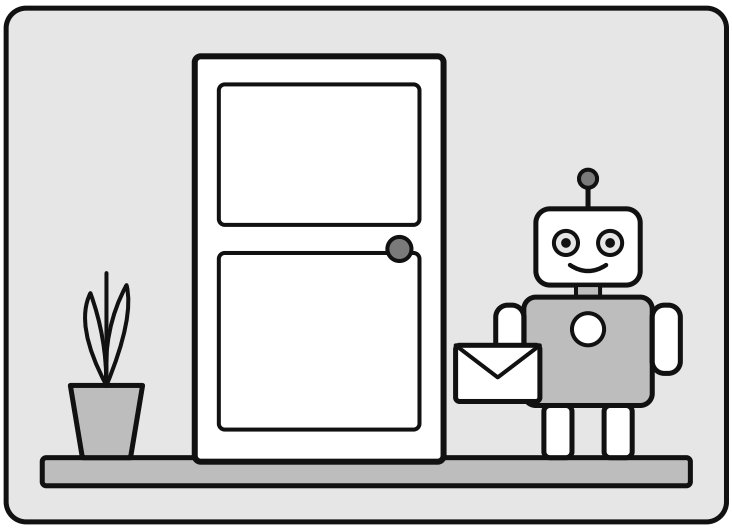
Why do you think the writer tells the story of George de Mestral?

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part 3: Writing

You have 10 minutes. **Choose** A or B. **Tick** the one you choose.

☐ **A The robot at the door**



Write a story about this picture. You can start like this: *One morning, there was a knock at the door.*

These questions can help you:

- Who opens the door?
- What does the robot want? What is in the envelope?
- What happens next?
- How does your story end?

☐ **B A letter to a new friend**

Write a letter to a student in your new class. Tell them about yourself. You can start like this: *Dear new friend,*

These ideas can help you:

- your family and your home
- what you like doing, and what you are good at
- what you want to learn at your new school

Plan

You can write words or draw pictures to plan.

Plan

Write here

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part 4: Maths

You have 18 minutes. You can use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. You cannot use a calculator.

You can ask your teacher to read a question to you. **Write** your answers in the boxes. You can use the working boxes.

Section A: Number problems

1 / 1

4 625 + 2 378 =

Working

2 / 1

12 × 9 =

3 / 1

Round 486 350 to the nearest 10 000.

4 / 1

Circle the largest number.

0.45 0.405 0.5 0.054

5 / 1

857 ÷ 6 =

remainder

Working

6 / 1

3 406 × 23 =

Working

7 / 1

Write the missing number.

$$2\frac{3}{4} = \frac{\square}{4}$$

8 / 1

$$\frac{2}{3} + \frac{1}{6} = \square$$

9 / 1

$736 \div 23 =$ ☐

Working

Section B: Word problems and pictures

10 / 2

This timetable shows three trains from Shanghai to Hangzhou.

Station	Train 1	Train 2	Train 3
Shanghai (leaves)	07:50	09:35	11:10
Jiaxing	08:18	10:02	11:41
Hangzhou (arrives)	08:46	10:31	12:09

(a) What time does Train 2 arrive in Jiaxing? ☐

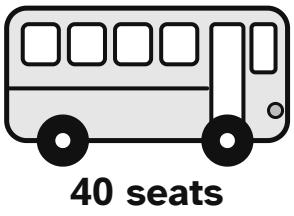
(b) How many minutes does Train 3 take from Shanghai to Hangzhou? ☐ minutes

11

/ 1

150 children go on a school trip. One bus can carry 40 children.

How many buses do they need?



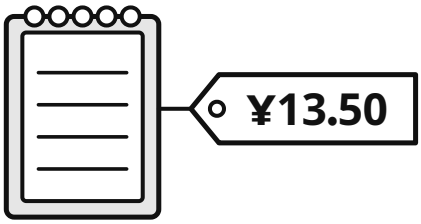
☐ buses

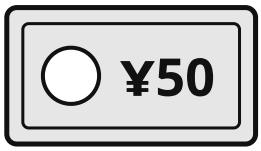
12

/ 2

Jun buys 3 notebooks. One notebook costs ¥13.50.

He pays with a ¥50 note. How much change does he get?





Working

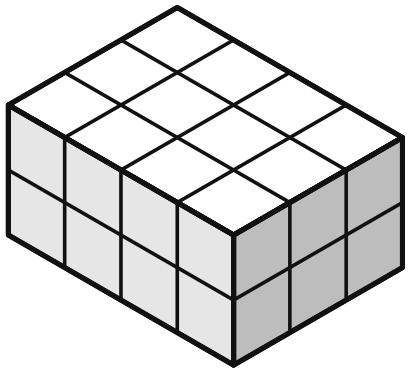
¥ ☐

13

/ 1

This cuboid is made of 1 cm cubes.

What is the **volume** of the cuboid?



☐ cm^3

14

/ 2

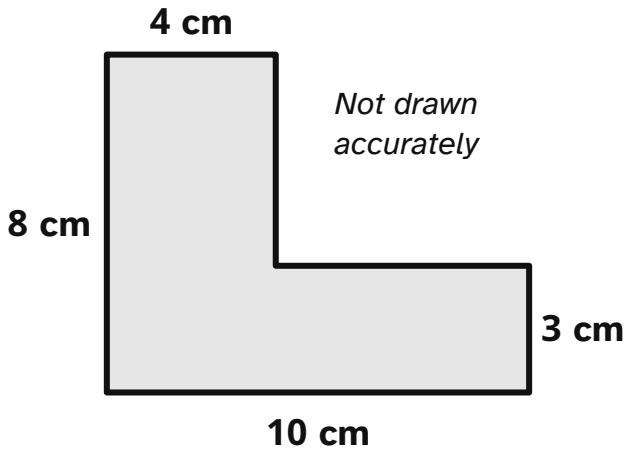
(a) What is the **perimeter** of this shape?

cm

(b) What is the **area** of this shape?

cm²

Working

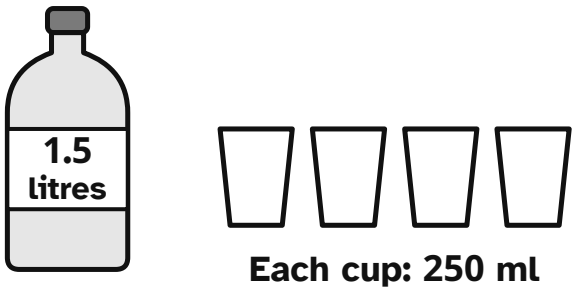


15

/ 1

A bottle has 1.5 litres of water. Sofia fills 4 cups from the bottle. Each cup holds 250 ml.

How much water is left in the bottle? **Write** your answer in ml.



ml

16

/ 1

Circle the **two** prime numbers.

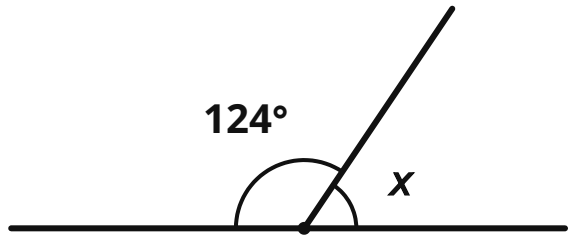
9	11	15	21	23	27

17

/ 2

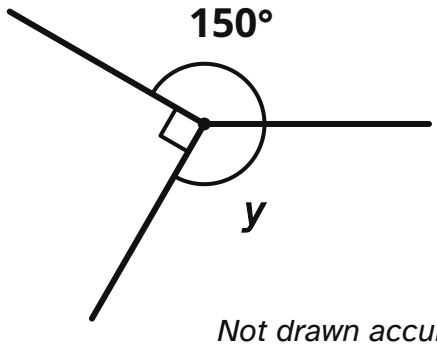
Work out the size of angle *x* and angle *y*. You do not need a protractor.

(a)



Not drawn accurately

(b)



Not drawn accurately

(a) x = ☐ ° (b) y = ☐ °

18

/ 1

There are 100 children in Year 6. The table shows how they come to school.

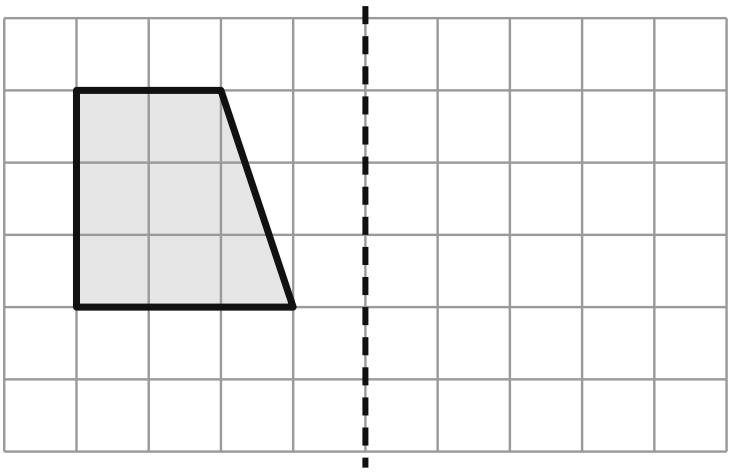
How they come to school	Number of children
walk	38
bus	27
car	?
Total	**100**

What **percentage** of the children come by car? ☐ %

19

/ 1

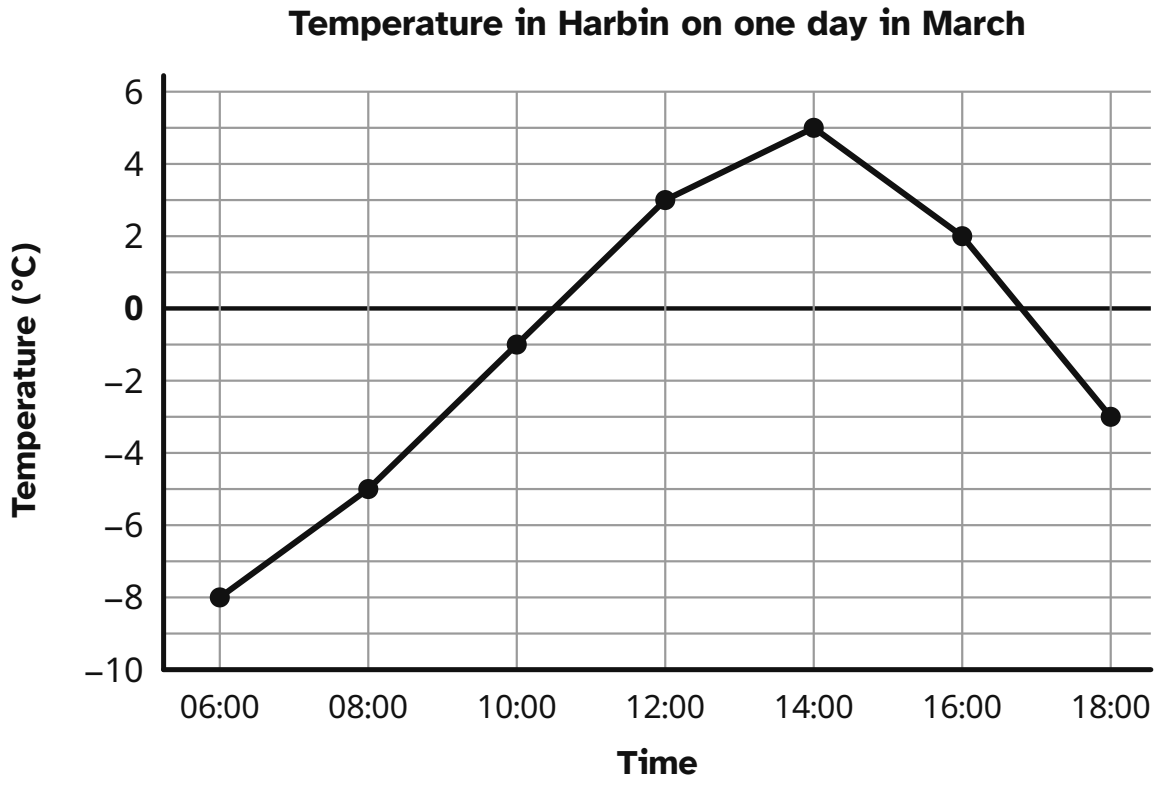
Draw the reflection of the shape in the mirror line. You can use a ruler.



mirror line

20

/ 2



(a) What was the temperature at 08:00? ☐ °C

(b) How many degrees **warmer** was it at 14:00 than at 06:00? ☐ degrees

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

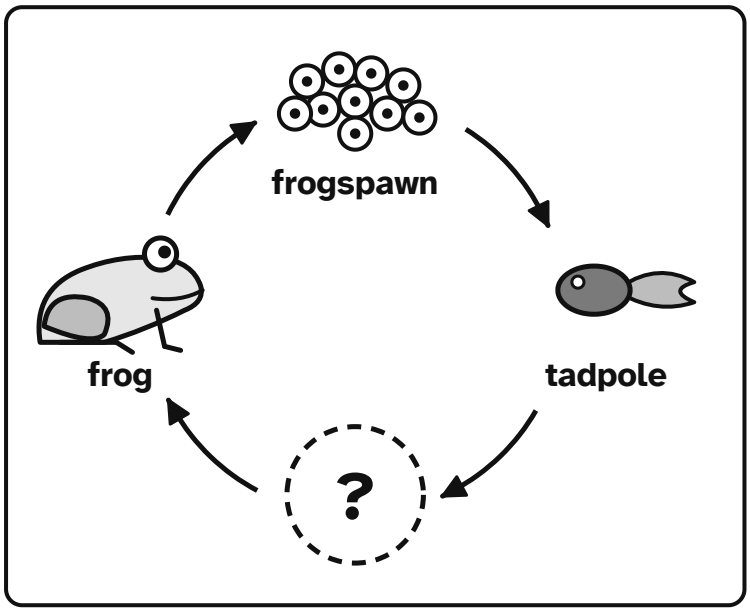
Part 5: Science

You have 8 minutes. You can ask your teacher to read a question to you.

1 / 1

This is the life cycle of a frog. One stage is missing.

Tick the picture of the missing stage.




A ☐


B ☐

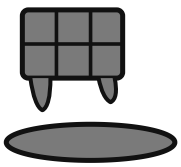

C ☐

2 / 2

Some changes can be changed back. They are **reversible**.

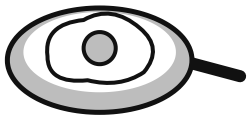
Some changes cannot be changed back. They are **irreversible**.

A



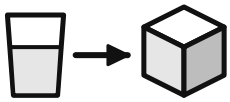
chocolate melts

B



an egg is fried

C



water freezes

D



paper burns

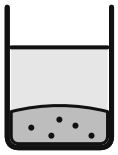
Write the letters A, B, C and D in the table.

Reversible (can be changed back)	**Irreversible (cannot be changed back)**

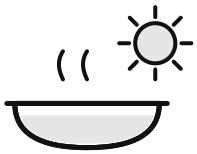
3

/ 2

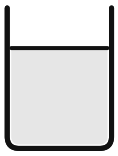
Join each mixture to the best way to separate it. Draw a line from dot to dot.



sand and water



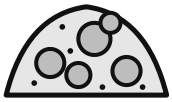
evaporating



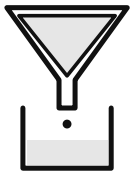
salt dissolved in water



sieving



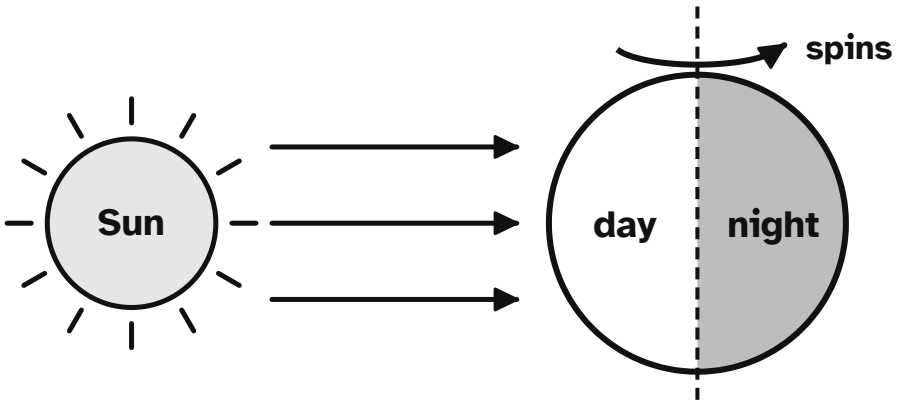
small stones and sand



filtering

4

/ 1



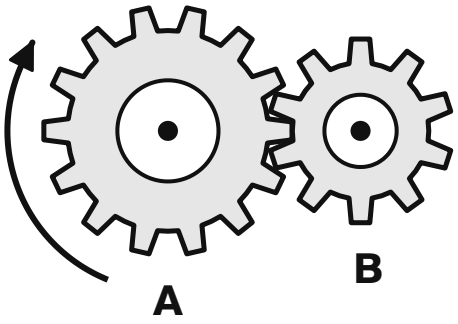
Not to scale

Why do we have day and night? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ The Earth spins around once every day.
- ☐ The Sun moves around the Earth every day.
- ☐ The Moon covers the Sun at night.
- ☐ The Earth moves around the Sun once every day.

5 / 1

Gear A turns clockwise. Which way does gear B turn? **Tick** one box.



- ☐ clockwise
- ☐ anticlockwise

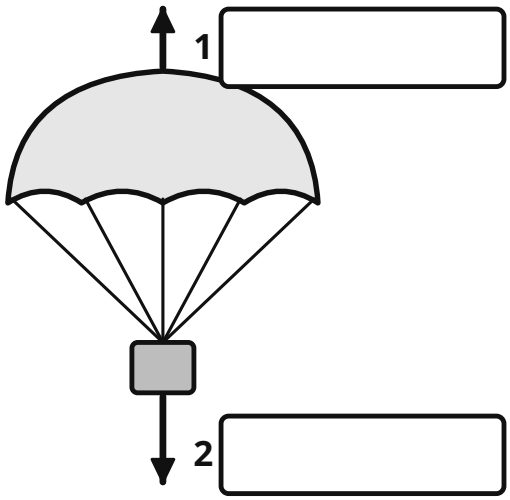
6 / 1

Mei drops a paper parachute. Two forces act on it.

Write the names of the two forces in boxes 1 and 2.

Use two of these words:

- **gravity**
- **air resistance**
- **magnetism**



7 / 2

Mei makes four paper parachutes of different sizes. She drops each one and times how long it takes to reach the floor.

Size of parachute	Time to fall (seconds)
10 cm by 10 cm	1.2
20 cm by 20 cm	1.8
30 cm by 30 cm	2.5
40 cm by 40 cm	3.1

(a) What does the table show? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ The bigger the parachute, the longer it takes to fall.
- ☐ The bigger the parachute, the faster it falls.
- ☐ The size of the parachute makes no difference.

(b) Mei wants a fair test. **Write** one thing she must keep the same.

Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.

Year 6 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor booklet

Version 3.1, October 2026. Same content as version 1. Use with `Y06/Y06_Student_Paper_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

For staff only. Use with the Year 6 student paper (`Y06/Y06_Student_Paper_v3.1`), the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`) and the interview record for Years 5 and 6 (`forms/Interview_Record_Y5_Y6`). The whole process, the English proficiency bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

Who this is for. Students joining UK Year 6 (age 10 to 11 in September). A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 4** (四年级); a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 5. The maths tests UK Year 5 content, with a few easier and a few harder items. The science tests UK Year 5 science and working scientifically.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student needs	Student paper pages
1	Welcome	2	Assessor (2.2)		1 (cover)
2	Listening	5	Assessor reads the script (3.1)	pencil	2 to 3
3	Reading paper, Parts A, B and C	12	Student alone; assessor keeps time (3.2)	pencil	4 to 9
4	Writing	10	Student alone (3.3)	pencil	10 to 11
	Break	3 to 5		water	
5	Maths	18	Student alone; assessor may read questions aloud (4)	pencil, rubber, ruler; no calculator, no protractor	12 to 17
6	Science	8	Student alone; assessor may read questions aloud (5)	pencil	18 to 21
7	Interview, opening with the sentence reading screen (start at **Level 5**)	12	Interviewer, 1:1 (3.4, 3.5)	sentence reading card; a plain card to cover sentences	
	Total student time	**about 65**, plus the break			

Print for each student: the student paper (21 pages, A4, printed at actual size: switch off "fit to page", because the diagrams and the type sizes depend on it); the sentence reading record; the interview record; the score summary (Section 6 of this booklet). **For each room:** a laminated sentence reading card, a clock or timer, spare pencils. The written papers can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; listening is read to the group; the interview is always 1:1.

Marks at a glance: listening / 8, reading / 24, writing / 16, maths / 25 (number problems / 9, word problems and pictures / 16, of which word problems / 5), science / 10.

2. Before you start

2.1 Set up

- A quiet, bright room. The student sits where they cannot see other students' papers.

- Write the student's name on the paper if they cannot (in English, with the Chinese name in brackets if the family uses one).
- Have this booklet open at 3.1 for the listening script, and a timer ready.

2.2 Welcome (say this)

> "Hello, I am _____. Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and plan how to help you. Some parts are easy and some parts are hard. That is fine. Do your best. If you do not understand what to do, you can ask me to say it again."

Show the cover page. Point to the "How to answer" examples and say: "Look. You tick a box, write in a box, circle, join with a line, and show your working like this."

2.3 Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English parts (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, or read the reading texts or reading questions aloud. The student may ask for instructions to be repeated in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as the student asks, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0, and the summary lists the NT topics.

Extra time or a reader for a known need is allowed: record it in the score summary. The number of **L** questions is evidence about English and goes in the summary.

2.4 Stopping rules

- In every part, a student may stop when they have done what they can. Encourage once ("Have a look at the next one; some are easier"), then accept their decision.
- **Listening:** always read the whole script twice, even if the student writes nothing.
- **Reading:** let the student work for the full 12 minutes. Stop early only if the student has answered nothing in Part A after 4 minutes, or is upset; record "stopped after 4 minutes".
- **Writing:** if the student cannot start, say once: "You can write words, or draw and label your plan." Never write for them.
- **Maths and science:** stop at the time. A student who is stuck may be told: "You can go on to the next question."
- A distressed child is never pressed: stop, take a break or end the session, and record it.

2.5 Keeping the student at ease

- Sit beside rather than opposite if you can. Smile, use the student's name, and praise effort ("Thank you, you are working hard"), not answers.
- Do not show marks or say whether an answer is right.
- Say how many parts are left. Offer water and the break after the writing.

3. English

3.1 Listening (5 minutes, / 8)

Say: "Turn to page 2. I am going to read a phone conversation between two friends, Aisha and Jun. They are talking about a film night in the park at Mid-Autumn. First I will read the questions to you. Then I will read the conversation two times. You can answer while I read. Answer on pages 2 and 3."

Read the questions aloud once, slowly, pointing to each number. Do not name or explain the pictures.

> "Question 1. Where will Aisha and Jun meet? Tick one box. Question 2. What time will they meet? Tick one box. Question 3. What must Jun bring? Tick two boxes. Question 4. Who is going to the film night with Aisha? Tick one box. Question 5. How wide is the screen? Question 6. What can they buy in the park? Question 7. Why does Aisha change the place where they meet? Question 8. Jun's piano lesson finishes at six o'clock. Will he be late? Tick yes or no, and explain your answer."

Say: "Now listen. I will read the conversation two times."

Read it twice at a natural, steady pace. Read both parts yourself: say each speaker's name before their words, and change your voice a little. Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, wait 20 seconds, then say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish.

> **Aisha:** Hello, Jun. It's Aisha. Are you still coming to the film night in the park on Saturday?
>
> **Jun:** Yes! My mum says I can go. Where shall we meet?
>
> **Aisha:** I said the main gate of Riverside Park, but it gets very crowded there. Let's meet outside the library instead. It's just across the road from the park. [pause]
>
> **Jun:** OK, outside the library. What time?
>
> **Aisha:** The film starts at seven o'clock, but we want to find a good place to sit. Can you be there at a quarter past six?
>
> **Jun:** A quarter past six. My piano lesson finishes at six, and it's only ten minutes from the library. So that's fine. [pause]
>
> **Aisha:** Great. My dad is coming with us, and my little brother, Leo.
>
> **Jun:** Do I need to bring anything?
>
> **Aisha:** Bring a jacket, because it gets cold by the river at night. And bring a little money, about twenty yuan. Dad says we can buy mooncakes there. [pause]
>
> **Jun:** Is the screen really big? My cousin says it's fifteen metres wide!
>
> **Aisha:** Yes, it's the biggest outdoor screen in the city. The film is about a panda who travels to the Moon, so it's perfect for Mid-Autumn. [pause]
>
> **Jun:** What if it rains?
>
> **Aisha:** Then the film night will be on Sunday instead. Dad will send your mum a message.
>
> **Jun:** Perfect. See you on Saturday!

Answers. 1 mark each. Spelling and grammar are not marked in listening; the answer must be in English and the meaning must be clear.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept	What it tests
1	**B** library		A park gate (the first plan, changed)	a change of plan
2	**B** 6:15		A 6:00 (the piano lesson ends), C 7:00 (the film starts)	"a quarter past"; distractor times

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept	What it tests
3	**A** jacket and **C** money	both ticked and nothing else	umbrella (rain is mentioned), torch (it will be dark, but she does not ask for one)	two details
4	her dad and her little brother		her cousin (only mentioned)	detail
5	**15**	fifteen	50 (fifteen and fifty sound alike)	number
6	mooncakes	moon cakes, mooncake, any recognisable spelling	a film; tickets	key word
7	The main gate gets very crowded.	crowded; too many people there; "many people"	"the library is near the park" (true, but not the reason)	reason stated in the text
8	**No**, because the lesson is only ten minutes from the library, so he gets there at about ten past six, before a quarter past six	No with any reason about the ten minutes or arriving before 6:15	Yes; No with no reason	inference: combines three facts

Band guide

Score	0 to 2	3 to 4	5 to 6	7	8
Listening band	**A**	**B**	**C**	**D**	**E**

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 4 need key words and pictures. A student who gets these but none of 5 to 8 usually knows familiar words but cannot yet follow connected speech (band B).
- Questions 1 and 2 have distractors: the first meeting place and the other times in the conversation. Choosing them shows the student caught words but missed the change ("instead", "but").
- Question 8 needs three facts combined (six o'clock, ten minutes, a quarter past six): it separates D from E.
- Compare with "listening in conversation" on the interview record.

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, / 24)

Say: "Turn to page 4. This is the reading. There are three parts: A, B and C. Read the texts and answer the questions. Part C is hard. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. I cannot help you with the words, but I can say the instructions again. You have 12 minutes."

Start the timer. Say "Two minutes left" at 10 minutes and "Please stop" at 12 minutes. Do not read any text or question aloud and do not explain words.

Marking. Spelling is not marked unless the word cannot be recognised. For "find and copy" the word must be the right word from the text; a small copying slip is fine. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: the café menu (questions 1 to 7, / 8)

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Notes
1	1	¥20	20, 20 yuan	
2	1	10	ten	
3	1	**A** noodle soup		uses the chilli picture and the key
4	1	milk tea		
5	1	20:00	8 pm, eight o'clock, 8 in the evening, 20.00	7:30 is the opening time
6	2	open on Mondays: **False**; fried rice costs more than an egg sandwich: **True**	1 mark each	the second needs a comparison (¥15 and ¥12)

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Notes
7	1	a drink	a free drink; any drink on the menu	"rice", "food"

Part B: The Rainy Day Picnic (questions 8 to 15, / 8). A story about two years below age level.

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
8	1	Sunday	on Sunday; Sunday morning	Saturday
9	1	fruit and a blanket	both ticked and nothing else	sandwiches (Mum made them)
10	1	red		
11	1	a (big) plant	plant; a flower pot	"a tree" (that is what she called it)
12	1	It started to rain.	it was raining; there was rain; dark clouds and rain	"it was cold"; "Tom was crying"
13	1	Tom's toy animals	toy animals; toys; animals	"a lion" on its own; "sandwiches"
14	1	sad		angry, hungry
15	1	They were enjoying the indoor picnic so much: it was fun, and they did not need the park any more.	any reason about enjoying the indoor picnic or having fun at home; "they were happy at home"	"because it was raining" (it had stopped); a retelling with no reason

Part C: How Seeds Travel (questions 16 to 23, / 8). Age-appropriate non-fiction for a fluent reader of 10.

Q	Marks	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
16	1	retrieval	a tiny parachute of soft hairs	parachute; soft hairs	the wind on its own
17	1	retrieval	Its thick, hairy outer layer traps air.	it has air inside; it is full of air	"it is big"; "it is light"
18	1	vocabulary	survive		grow
19	1	vocabulary in context	move slowly with the water		
20	1	vocabulary in context	being carried by an animal		
21	1	retrieval and inference	any one: too much shade or not enough light; they must share water; they must share space	too dark; no sun; too crowded; not enough water	"the parent eats them"
22	1	inference: applies the text	The seed passes through the bird's body and is dropped in the garden (in its droppings) after the bird flies there.	the bird carries the seed inside it to the garden; the bird drops the seed there	"the wind blows it" (no link to the bird)
23	1	author's purpose	To give a real example: the hooks on burdock seeds gave a person the idea for Velcro.	to show that nature can give people ideas; to make the text more interesting with a true story; to link seeds to something children know	retelling ("because he had a dog")

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C** Developing competence

Result	Band
Part C 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part C 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example, Part C higher than Part B), and check against the sentence reading screen.

What to look for

- **Picture support.** A student who scores mainly on questions 1 to 3 may be using the menu pictures and prices, not the words.
- **Copying.** A pattern of copying words that sit next to the question words suggests word matching without understanding (for example "the wind can carry them" for question 16).
- **Inference and purpose.** Questions 21 to 23 separate D from E. A student at band C often gets the retrieval questions and leaves the "why" and "explain" questions blank.
- **Speed.** A student who is accurate but does not reach Part C may decode slowly: check the fluency rating on the sentence reading record before giving a low band.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, / 16)

Say: "Turn to page 10. This is the writing. Choose A or B, and tick the one you choose. You can plan in the box on page 11, then write on the lines. Write as much as you can. You have 10 minutes."

The task. A: a story that starts when a small robot with an envelope knocks at the door (picture and question prompts). B: a letter to a student in the new class about themselves (prompts for content). Do not give a higher mark for either choice. In B, the content tells you about the student too: pass anything useful to the interviewer.

Criteria. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 sit between the descriptions). Total / 16.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or only words copied from the page	A few connected ideas on the topic in a simple order; may be short (3 to 6 sentences) or a list; a letter may have no opening or ending	A complete piece that fits the task: a story with an opening, a problem and an ending, or a letter with a greeting, several developed points and a closing; ideas link across sentences; paragraphs
Vocabulary	No English words, or single words not on the topic	Everyday words that carry the meaning; a few topic words; much repetition (nice, good, like)	Varied, precise words for a 10 year old: chosen verbs, adjectives and adverbs; some ambitious words used correctly
Grammar and sentences	No sentences	Simple sentences with mostly correct word order, joined with and, then, because; frequent errors in tense, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear	A range of sentences (with when, if, because, although, so that); tenses controlled; errors are rare and do not affect meaning
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling cannot be read; no punctuation	Common words mostly correct, others spelt as they sound; capital letters and full stops sometimes	Most words correct, including less common ones; sentence punctuation secure; commas, apostrophes and speech marks mostly correct

The writing band is given by best fit with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, not by the total alone. As a rough guide only: totals of 0 to 3 usually fit **A**, 4 to 7 **B**, 8 to 10 **C**, 11 to 13 **D**, 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E at this age. A fluent writer of 10 to 11 usually writes about 120 to 200 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with a clear opening and ending suited to the form (a story ending, or a letter's closing such as "I hope to meet you soon"). Sentences vary in length and type, vocabulary is chosen for effect, and dialogue in a story is mostly punctuated correctly. Common words are spelt correctly and harder words plausibly. The errors are the ones any 10 year old makes, not the features of a learner of English (missing "a" and "the", missing past tense -ed or plural -s, Chinese word order).

What to look for

- **Learner features** (missing -s, -ed, articles; "I very like"; "There have many …") point to C or D even when the content is good.
- **Memorised chunks** in letter B ("My name is … I am 10 years old. My hobby is …") with little else usually fit B. Look for what the student adds beyond the textbook pattern.
- **A full plan and little writing** may mean slow writing in English rather than no ideas: say so in the notes.

3.4 Speaking: the interview (about 8 minutes of questions)

Use `forms/Interview_Record_Y5_Y6`. The interviewer records the speaking band and "listening in conversation" on that form; copy the speaking band into Section 6. If the listening task (3.1) and listening in conversation differ by more than one band, note why.

3.5 Reading aloud: the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (opens the interview, 3 to 4 minutes)

Use `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`. **Start at Level 5 (sentence 13)** for Year 6. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Follow the record's rules for going back, stopping and the meaning checks. Copy the total points (/ 72), reading age, meaning checks and fluency rating into Section 6. Use the "Years 6 to 10" column of the record's table to turn the reading age into an indicative band, and use it to confirm the reading paper band.

4. Maths (18 minutes, / 25)

Say: "Turn to page 12. This is maths. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and pictures. You can use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. If you want me to read a question to you, put up your hand. You have 18 minutes."

What it tests. UK Year 5 content, with easier floor items (Year 4) and ceiling items (Year 6). Section A, number problems: 9 marks. Section B, word problems and pictures: 16 marks, of which **word problems: 5 marks** (questions 11, 12, 15 and 18). Every Section B question has a picture, chart, table or diagram.

Marking. Give the mark for a correct answer with or without working. Units are printed in the answer boxes, so they are not needed. Accept answers in a different but correct form unless the question asks for a particular form.

4.1 Section A: number problems (/ 9)

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught (Chinese Grade 4 completed)
1	Add 4-digit numbers (Y4, floor)	1	7 003	7003	6 993, 7 993: carrying slips	
2	12 times table (Y4, floor)	1	108		98, 118	The 11 and 12 times tables are often not learnt (tables go to 9 × 9). Working it out (10 × 9 + 2 × 9) is good reasoning.
3	Round to the nearest 10 000 (Y5)	1	490 000	490000	480 000 (cuts off), 486 000, 500 000	Usually taught in Grade 4 with 四舍五入 to the nearest 万 (48万6350 ≈ 49万), so this should be familiar; the digit grouping in threes may look new.
4	Compare decimals to 3 places (Y5)	1	0.5 circled		0.405 or 0.054: thinks more digits means bigger	Comparing decimals is usually Grade 4.
5	Short division with a remainder (Y5)	1	142 remainder 5	142 r 5; 142..... 5 (Chinese notation); 142 5/6	143 (rounds up), 141 remainder 11 (remainder bigger than 6)	Division with remainders (有余数的除法) is taught from Grade 2; the word "remainder" may be new.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught (Chinese Grade 4 completed)
6	4-digit × 2-digit (Y5)	1	78 338	78338	17 030: multiplies by 2 instead of 20 in the second row	Three-digit × two-digit is Grade 4; the method is the same.
7	Mixed number to improper fraction (Y5)	1	11		9 (2 + 3 + 4), 6, 14	Mixed numbers and improper fractions (带分数, 假分数) are usually Grade 5.
8	Add fractions with related denominators (Y5)	1	5/6	10/12 or any equivalent	3/9: adds tops and bottoms	Adding fractions with different denominators (异分母分数加法) is usually Grade 5.
9	Long division (Y6, ceiling)	1	32		31 remainder 23	Division by a two-digit number is Grade 4, so many students will get this.

4.2 Section B: word problems and pictures (/ 16)

W = word problem.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
10	Read a timetable; time intervals (Y5)	2	(a) 10:02 (b) 59 minutes	1 mark each	(b) 99 (subtracts the times like decimals: 12.09 – 11.10), 61, 1 hour 1 minute	Time intervals (经过的时间) are Grade 3; a UK-style timetable may be new.
11 W	Division: use the remainder (Y5)	1	4 buses	4	3 remainder 30, 3.75, 3: does not round up for the context	
12 W	Money with decimals, two steps (Y5)	2	¥9.50	9.5; 9元5角. 2 marks: 9.50. 1 mark: 40.50 (3 × 13.50) seen with no correct second step, or a correct method with one slip	36.50 (50 – 13.50: forgets the 3 notebooks); 40.50 as the final answer	Decimal money calculation is Grade 4.
13	Volume by counting cubes (Y5)	1	24 cm^3	24	12 (counts the top only), 26 (counts the squares you can see: 12 + 8 + 6)	Volume (体积) is usually Grade 5; counting hidden cubes may be new.
14	Perimeter and area of a composite shape (Y5)	2	(a) 36 cm (b) 50 cm^2	1 mark each	(a) 25: adds only the four labelled sides; (b) 80 (10 × 8, ignores the missing corner)	Rectangle area and perimeter are Grade 3; composite shapes (组合图形) are usually Grade 5. Finding the missing sides (6 cm and 5 cm) is the skill.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
15 W	Measures: litres and ml, two steps (Y5)	1	500 ml	500	0.5 (right amount but in litres: 0, note it), 1 250 (subtracts one cup), 1 000	Litres and millilitres (升和毫升) are Grade 4 in some textbooks and Grade 5 in PEP.
16	Prime numbers (Y5)	1	11 and 23 circled, and nothing else		9, 15, 21, 27 circled: thinks odd numbers are prime	Prime numbers (质数) are usually Grade 5.
17	Angles on a straight line and around a point (Y5)	2	(a) 56° (b) 120°	1 mark each	(a) 124 (copies), 236; (b) 30, 210 (forgets the right angle)	平角 (180°) and 周角 (360°) are usually Grade 4, so this should be familiar.
18 W	Percentages as hundredths (Y5)	1	35%	35	65 (adds the two numbers given)	Percentages (百分数) are usually Grade 6; a student may still reason that 35 out of 100 is 35%.
19	Reflection in a mirror line (Y5)	1	The reflected shape is on the right of the line, the same distances away: its long upright side is 4 squares right of the line, its top runs from 2 to 4 squares right, its bottom from 1 to 4 squares right, and its sloping side is nearest the line.	Small drawing inaccuracy if every corner is in the right square	The same shape slid across (sloping side on the far side): a translation, not a reflection	Reflection on a grid (轴对称) is usually Grade 4, so this should be familiar.
20	Line graph with negative numbers (Y5; (b) is a Y6 ceiling item)	2	(a) –5 °C (b) 13 degrees	1 mark each; (a) "minus 5", "5 below zero"	(a) 5 or –6; (b) 3 or –3: works out 5 – 8 instead of 5 – (–8)	Line graphs (折线统计图) are usually Grade 5 and negative numbers Grade 6.

Band guide (provisional)

Score / 25	0 to 9	10 to 14	15 to 21	22 to 25
Maths band	**1** Well below expected	**2** Working towards	**3** Expected	**4** Greater depth

List the NT questions and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

Topics that may not have been taught to a student who has completed Chinese Grade 4: the 12 times table (2), mixed numbers and improper fractions (7), adding fractions with different denominators (8), volume (13), composite shapes (14), litres and millilitres (15), prime numbers (16), percentages (18), line graphs and negative numbers (20). Rounding large numbers, decimals, long multiplication and division, time, money, angles on a line and around a point, and reflection (1, 3 to 6, 9 to 12, 17, 19) are usually taught by the end of Grade 4. Textbooks differ (PEP, 苏教版, 北师大版), so always ask the student.

4.3 What to look for

- **Number problems against word problems.** A student who scores well on number problems (Section A) but poorly on the word problems (11, 12, 15, 18) may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. Check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the answer then comes quickly, record it as an English barrier.

- **Method.** Students from Chinese schools often calculate quickly and accurately. A correct answer without working is fine. When an answer is wrong, look at the working: one slip in a sound method is a different need from a wrong method.
- **Conventions.** "Remainder" in words, timetables, "Not drawn accurately", cm^3 and the percentage sign may be new. A student who shows the maths correctly with a picture or working knows the maths, even if the English words are new.

5. Science (8 minutes, / 10)

Say: "Turn to page 18. This is science. Every question has a picture or a table. If you want me to read a question to you, put up your hand. You have 8 minutes."

What it tests. UK Year 5 science and working scientifically. Question 7 is the table and fair test question.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers	May not have been taught
1	Life cycle of an amphibian (Y5)	1	**A** (the young frog with legs and a tail)		B fish: thinks a tadpole becomes a fish	Life cycles (for example the silkworm, 动物的一生) are often taught by Grade 3, so the idea should be familiar.
2	Reversible and irreversible changes (Y5)	2	Reversible: A, C. Irreversible: B, D.	2 marks: all four correct; 1 mark: three correct	A under irreversible: thinks melted chocolate cannot set again	Reversible and irreversible changes are often later (Grade 6 in some textbooks); the meaning of the two words is given on the page.
3	Separating mixtures (Y5)	2	sand and water: filtering; salt dissolved in water: evaporating; small stones and sand: sieving	2 marks: all three; 1 mark: one or two correct	salt water joined to filtering: thinks filtering removes dissolved salt	Dissolving (溶解) is usually Grade 4; separating by filtering and evaporating may be new.
4	Day and night (Y5)	1	The Earth spins around once every day.		"The Sun moves around the Earth": an everyday idea, not an English problem	The Earth's movement is often Grade 5 or 6.
5	Gears (Y5)	1	anticlockwise	an anticlockwise arrow drawn on gear B	clockwise	Simple machines (levers, pulleys and gears) are often Grade 6. The arrows on the page show the meaning of the two words.
6	Forces: gravity and air resistance (Y5)	1	1 air resistance, 2 gravity	both for the mark, in English; spelling not marked; an answer in Chinese scores 0	the two swapped; magnetism	Forces are taught in different grades; the English names may be new.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers	May not have been taught
7	Reading a table; conclusion; fair test (Y5, working scientifically)	2	(a) The bigger the parachute, the longer it takes to fall. (b) any one: the same height; the same weight or load; the same paper or material; the same strings; drop it the same way or in the same place	1 mark each; (b) "same toy", "same high"	(b) "same size" (that is what she changes), "same time" (that is what she measures)	Fair testing in this form is less familiar; judge the student's thinking.

Band guide (provisional)

Score / 10	0 to 3	4 to 5	6 to 8	9 to 10
Science band	**1** Well below expected	**2** Working towards	**3** Expected	**4** Greater depth

What to look for

- **Working scientifically.** Question 7 shows scientific thinking separately from topic knowledge. A student who gets 7 right but marks other questions NT is likely to do well once taught.
- **An English barrier** looks like wrong answers that depend on English words (reversible, evaporating, air resistance) while the picture questions (1, 5) are right. Reading the question aloud, or once in Chinese (L), usually settles it.
- **Everyday ideas** (the Sun moves around the Earth; heavier things always fall faster) are science misconceptions, not English problems.

6. Score summary

Complete on the day and copy onto `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening	/ 8	A B C D E	
Reading paper	/ 24 (A / 8, B / 8, C / 8)	A B C D E	
Sentence reading (shared record)	points / 72; reading age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative A B C D E	
Writing	/ 16 (content __ vocabulary __ grammar __ spelling __)	A B C D E	
Speaking (from the interview)		A B C D E	
Maths	/ 25 (A / 9, B / 16, of which word problems / 5)	1 2 3 4	NT: L:
Science	/ 10	1 2 3 4	NT: L:

Overall English band (the band most of the four skills sit in; name any skill two or more bands lower)	A B C D E
Number problems against word problems (Section A / 9, word problems / 5): English barrier in maths?	yes / no / unsure
Access arrangements (extra time, reader, breaks)	
Behaviour and wellbeing during the assessment	

Assessor's comment (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not) _____

_____

Assessor signature and date _____

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: assessor record

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Age today (years:months)	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Assessor	

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this record, a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening).

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"

Code	Error	Example
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (mark them, but do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said in the notes. Patterns in the notes (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in the record). Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Record ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood). The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is recorded ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Record

Level 1 (sentences 1 to 3)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
1	I can see a red bus.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
2	The cat sat on my bed.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
3	Dad has a big hat.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 2 (sentences 4 to 6)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
6	They like to play in the park.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 3 (sentences 7 to 9)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 4 (sentences 10 to 12)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 5 (sentences 13 to 15)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 6 (sentences 16 to 18)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 7 (sentences 19 to 21)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 8 (sentences 22 to 24)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 9 (sentences 25 to 27)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 10 (sentences 28 to 30)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 11 (sentences 31 to 33)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 12 (sentences 34 to 36)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Total points	/ 72
Reading age	
Actual age (years:months)	
Difference (reading age minus actual age)	
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	
Fluency rating (1 to 4)	
Patterns noticed	

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and

structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Copy to the Candidate Summary: total points, reading age, actual age, meaning checks, fluency, indicative band, one line on patterns.

Student interview and suitability record: Years 5 and 6

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 12 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start Level 4 for Year 5, Level 5 for Year 6; record on `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`).

How to ask. Smile, sit beside rather than opposite the child if you can, and start with something easy. Ask the main question first. If the child struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a child tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Sentence reading (3 to 4 minutes)

Total points ___ / 72 Reading age _____ Meaning checks ___ Fluency ___ (details on the sentence reading record)

2. Questions (8 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. Tick the ones you used and write short notes: what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Warm-up	Tell me about yourself and your family.	What is your name? Do you have a brother or sister?	What do you like doing together as a family?	
	What did you do last weekend?	Did you go out or stay at home?	What was the best part, and why?	
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is one thing you would change about it?	
	What do you find hard at school? What do you do then?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you learnt something hard.	
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read English books?	What helps you remember new words?	
	How do you feel about having all your lessons in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What do you think will be hardest?	
Interests	What do you like to do after school and at weekends?	Do you like sport, music, art or games?	What are you best at, and how did you get good at it?	

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
	Tell me about a book, film or game you like.	Do you like reading?	Why do you like it? Who would you recommend it to?	
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about it?	
Friends and feelings	Tell me about your friends.	Do you have a best friend?	What makes someone a good friend?	
	What do you do when you feel sad or worried?	Who do you talk to?		
	How do you feel about starting a new school?	Are you happy, nervous, or both?	What would help you settle in?	
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to be when you grow up? Why?	Do you have a dream job?	What do you need to learn to do that job?	
	Is there a place in the world you would like to visit or live in?	China or another country?	What do you think it would be like?	
	Why do you want to come to our school?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope to learn here?	
Values (choose one)	Your friend breaks a classmate's pencil and says nothing. What do you do?	Is that OK?	Why?	
	A new student cannot speak your language and sits alone. What do you do?	Would you play with them?	How could you help them?	
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?		

3. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best, for a child of this age.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single words and memorised phrases. Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported with pictures or gesture.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences about familiar things (family, school, likes). Frequent errors. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with short connected sentences ("because", "and then", "but"). Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Everyday vocabulary.
D Competent	Talks easily and at some length, explains and gives examples, manages most stretch prompts. Occasional errors that rarely affect meaning.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the child is easy to understand):

4. Suitability

Rate each strand from what you saw and heard. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning and resilience	Keen to learn, has a go, keeps trying when work is hard	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest, enjoys talking about ideas	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Settles with a new adult, talks about friends, manages nerves, ready for a new school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence and self-management	Follows instructions, looks after belongings, can work alone for a short time, will ask for help	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and polite in the interview and the values question	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for English-medium learning	Happy to try speaking English even with mistakes, interested in learning English	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Boarding readiness (only if the child will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rating ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 Evidence:

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision, coordination)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example anxiety, very heavy after-school workload, sleep)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

If the child's likely homeroom teacher meets them, note first impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, a picture word book, seating near the teacher).

Interviewer signature and date _____

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Candidate summary and decision

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Paper version sat: _____ (for example v3.1; it is on the front page and in the footer of every paper)

Complete within two working days, from the assessor booklet, reading records, interview record, parent conversation and homeroom teacher reference. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (scores)	Band
Listening	Listening task ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation	**A B C D E**
Speaking	Interview (and picture talk, Years 1 to 3)	**A B C D E**
Reading	Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics words ___ / 40 ; letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 6: reading paper ___ / 24 (A ___ B ___ C ___). Years 7 to 10: reading paper ___ / 16 (A ___ B ___)	**A B C D E**
Reading aloud	Sentence reading: points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative **A B C D E**
Writing	Writing task ___ / 16	**A B C D E**
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	**A B C D E**

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems (Years 7 to 10: fluency)	Word problems (Years 7 to 10: word questions)	Applied (Years 7 to 10)	Not yet taught (NT)	Language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**	___ / ___	___ / ___	___ / 12		
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**					

1 Well below expected (Years 7 to 10: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The Years 7 to 10 papers are harder, so their band boundaries are lower (guide and booklets). A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. In Years 7 to 10, a student strong in fluency and word questions but weak in applied problems needs teaching in problem solving, not more content. Questions marked NT score 0; say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Year 10 only: readiness for IGCSE (Year 10 assessor booklet, Section 6). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet.

Assessor's comment on maths and science (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not):

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Student interview (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Head of section			
Admissions			
Outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			